

Silence is the subject.

Status is what the user sets. Silence is what happened to them. This system gives silence its own scale, its own colour and its own way of fading a card toward the page — and keeps it visually separate from Status, so the two never argue.

One accent hue for the brand and three for meaning, all at the same lightness and chroma, so **no status can win an argument by being brighter**. Two faces: a high-contrast serif for numbers and headlines, a plain grotesque for everything you actually read.

DOCUMENT

Design system for the job tracker web app, extension side panel and shared UI package.

SOURCE OF TRUTH

docs/design-system.md, and one @theme block in packages/tailwind-config.

DRAWN VERSION

The canvas in .scratch/design-ghosted-boo — board, detail, states, sign-in, side panel, parts list.

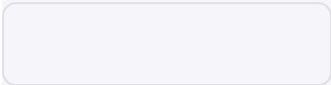
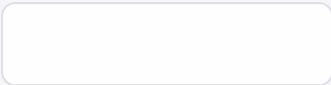
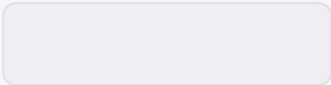
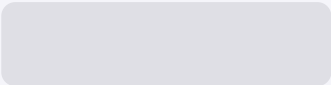
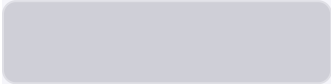
DATE

7
September
2026

Tokens

All of it comes out of one @theme block in packages/tailwind-config/shared-styles.css, which both apps/web and packages/ui import — so StatusBadge and the web app cannot drift.

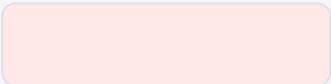
GROUND AND INK

			
paper oklch(.972 .006 285) Page ground	paper-raised oklch(.998 .002 285) Cards, panels, fields, app bar	paper-sunk oklch(.951 .008 285) Panel and table headers, row hover	line oklch(.905 .008 285) Borders, dividers
			
line-strong oklch(.858 .010 285) Control borders, column rules	ink-faint oklch(.530 .014 285) Meta, placeholders	ink-muted oklch(.420 .018 285) Secondary text, body prose	ink oklch(.215 .022 285) Primary text, primary button fill

Every neutral carries the same **285° hue** at very low chroma, so the greys read as a cool bone-white paper rather than as switched-off colour.

Never use opacity to dim text. It double-dims over a tinted background and cannot be tuned per surface — that is why the badges and the failure banner currently look muddier than they should. Use ink-muted / ink-faint.

ACCENTS — ONE BRAND HUE, THREE SEMANTICS

			
spectre · 298° oklch(.520 .120 298) Brand, Applied, links, focus ring	ember · 62° oklch(.520 .120 62) Interviewing, going cold, partial, excitement	vital · 152° oklch(.520 .120 152) Offer, Coverage you have	rose · 18° oklch(.520 .120 18) Rejected, missing, closing, destructive
			
spectre-tint oklch(.945 .032 298) The same hue as a fill	ember-tint oklch(.951 .036 68) The same hue as a fill	vital-tint oklch(.949 .036 155) The same hue as a fill	rose-tint oklch(.953 .030 20) The same hue as a fill

All four accents sit at **L 0.52 / C 0.12** and differ only in hue, so a green badge and a red badge carry exactly the same visual weight and no Status can win an argument by being brighter.

0.12 is the ceiling, not a preference. It is the most these four hues can hold at that lightness and stay inside sRGB. Push it and the browser silently clips ember and vital, shifting their hue without telling you. Each accent reads at **4.5:1 or better on its own tint**.

DARK

The same table with paper and ink swapped and the accents lifted to **L 0.735 / C 0.145** — same four hues, so no component has to know which theme it is in.

```
--paper 0.183 0.018 288 --paper-raised 0.228 0.020 288 --paper-sunk 0.268 0.020 288
--ink 0.958 0.005 288 --ink-muted 0.755 0.014 288 --ink-faint 0.620 0.016 288
--line 0.318 0.018 288 --line-strong 0.382 0.020 288
accents spectre / ember / vital / rose oklch(0.735 0.145 <hue>)
tints spectre 0.315 0.058 298 · ember 0.300 0.052 62
vital 0.292 0.052 152 · rose 0.308 0.058 18
```

THE @THEME BLOCK

```
/* packages/tailwind-config/shared-styles.css — replaces the three orphan
   --color-* - 1000 values left over from the create-turbo starter */
@import "tailwindcss";

@theme {
  --color-paper:          oklch(0.972 0.006 285);
  --color-paper-raised:  oklch(0.998 0.002 285);
  --color-paper-sunk:     oklch(0.951 0.008 285);
  --color-line:           oklch(0.905 0.008 285);
  --color-line-strong:    oklch(0.858 0.010 285);
  --color-ink:            oklch(0.215 0.022 285);
  --color-ink-muted:      oklch(0.420 0.018 285);
  --color-ink-faint:      oklch(0.530 0.014 285);

  --color-spectre:        oklch(0.520 0.120 298); /* brand · Applied */
  --color-spectre-tint:   oklch(0.945 0.032 298);
  --color-ember:          oklch(0.520 0.120 62);  /* Interviewing · going cold */
  --color-ember-tint:     oklch(0.951 0.036 68);
  --color-vital:          oklch(0.520 0.120 152); /* Offer · have it */
  --color-vital-tint:     oklch(0.949 0.036 155);
  --color-rose:           oklch(0.520 0.120 18);  /* Rejected · missing */
  --color-rose-tint:      oklch(0.953 0.030 20);

  --font-display: "Instrument Serif", "Iowan Old Style", Georgia, serif;
  --radius-tag: 4px; --radius-control: 5px;
  --radius-card: 9px; --radius-panel: 11px;
}
```

The starter body gradient in `apps/web/app/globals.css` goes with it.

Type

THE RAMP

DISPLAY

Instrument Serif ·
48/1.02

Stripe

STATEMENT

Instrument Serif ·
37/1.12

14 tracked. 3 have gone quiet.

SECTION

Instrument Serif ·
26/1.15

Nothing out there yet.

TITLE

Public Sans 600 ·
14/1.3

Senior Product Engineer

BODY

Public Sans 400 ·
13.5/1.55

The Posting asks for services that survive a region going down. Your CV describes queue-backed workers and a read replica.

META

Public Sans 400 ·
12/1.4

Saved 14 Aug · applied 15 Aug · last changed 3 Sep

EYEBROW

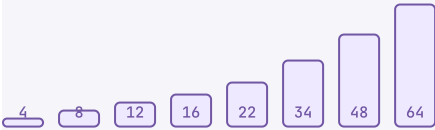
Public Sans 600 ·
10.5, .09em caps

REQUIREMENTS

Instrument Serif has one weight. Never let a browser synthesise bold on it — headline emphasis comes from colour and size, never a heavier cut. Public Sans is the workhorse and is metric-compatible enough with the **Geist** already installed in `apps/web/app/layout.tsx` that Geist can stay for UI if you would rather ship only the one new font. `font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums` on body, everywhere — counts must not shuffle as they change.

Metrics

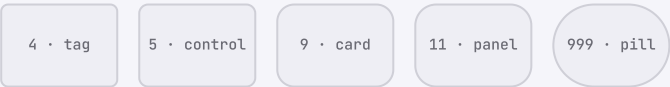
SPACING · 4PX BASE



Card padding 12, panel padding 18, page gutter 64, section gap 20–34.

Focus is `border-color: spectre plus box-shadow: 0 0 0 3px spectre-tint` on fields, and `outline: 2px solid spectre; outline-offset: 2px` on cards and icon buttons. Never remove it.

RADII



Tighter than the `rounded-md` used today. Controls 34px tall (28 small, 40–42 on sign-in); **every hit target on a phone stays at 44px.**

Components

The Status pill and the silence tag are deliberately different shapes — round versus rectangular — so the two axes never read as one thing.

THE PARTS

STATUS

Bookmarked

Applied

Interviewing

Offer

Rejected

Withdrawn

SILENCE

Quiet · 12d

Going cold · 34d

Ghosted · 61d

Closes in 3d

COVERAGE

Have it

Partly · analysed

Missing

Have it · yours

7/9

5/8

4/9

BUTTONS

Save changes

Run it again

Delete

Saving...

FIELDS

Company or job title

Stripe

Company is required.

ICONS · 24 GRID

1.7px stroke, round caps, currentCoLor, no fills except the ghost's eyes. Never emoji.

STATUS PILL — THE ONLY THING CARRYING STATUS COLOUR

STATUS	FILL	TEXT
Bookmarked	paper-sunk	ink-muted
Applied	spectre-tint	spectre
Interviewing	ember-tint	ember
Offer	vital-tint	vital
Rejected	rose-tint	rose
Withdrawn	transparent, 1px line-strong inset ring	ink-faint

THE SILENCE LADDER

FRESH · 0-7 days

Anthropic
Research Engineer

7/9

No tag at all.

QUIET · 8–20 days

Vercel
Developer Experience Engineer

8/9 Quiet · 12d

Bordered tag, no colour yet.

GOING COLD · 21–44 days

Stripe
Senior Product Engineer

5/8 Going cold · 34d

Dashed ember border on the card.

GHOSTED · 45 days and up

Figma
Product Designer

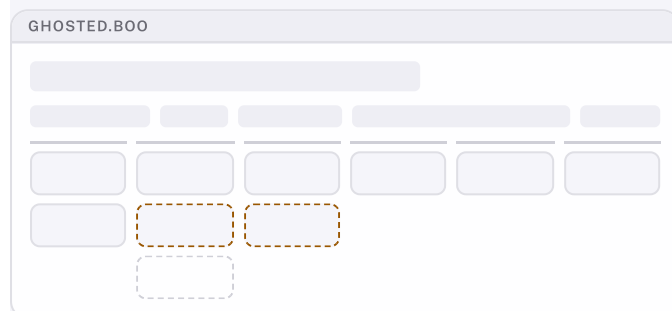
4/9 Ghosted · 61d

Card fades toward the page; ghost at 5%.

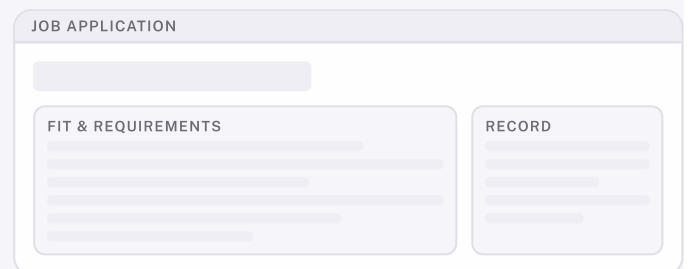
Silence is counted from the last thing that actually happened, and applies only where the user is waiting on somebody — an **Applied** or **Interviewing** Job Application. A Bookmarked one has nobody to hear from; an Offer, a Rejection or a Withdrawal has already been answered. A closing date takes the tag slot when there is no silence to report.

The card fades toward the page as silence grows — it never turns red. Ghosting is an absence, not an error.

Layout



Board — tally, toolbar, count line, six columns at $\text{minmax}(0, 1\text{fr})$, 14px gap, 8px between cards.



Job Application — minmax(0,1fr) 396px. Left is what you came to read; right is the record and the machinery.

App bar 60px, paper-raised, 1px line bottom, 64px gutters. Wordmark left (ghosted in ink, . boo in ink-faint), Your Profile / Track a job / avatar right.

The tally is the statement serif and the app's only piece of first-person arithmetic — *"14 tracked. 6 still in the air. 3 have gone quiet on you."* The quiet number is spectre; the words around the numbers are ink-faint.

Table view is the same data in a radius-10 wrap with a paper-sunk header. It exists because six columns stop working around fifty Job Applications. **The side panel** is 400px of the same system one step down: 48px bar, 14px padding, 32px fields — and a field the extension read off the Posting carries a 2.5px spectre left border, so what was read is distinguishable from what was typed.

Voice

Dry, never chirpy — and it stops being funny the moment the user has a problem to solve.

THE WIT LIVES HERE

Nothing out there yet.

Track your first job and the board fills itself in. Or open the extension on a Posting you are already reading and save it from the page.

No sign of it.

No Job Application at that Status carries what you searched for. The filters are doing more work than you meant them to.

Nobody is ignoring you.

Every job you are waiting on has been heard from in the last week. Enjoy it — this is not the usual state of affairs.

AND NOWHERE NEAR HERE

Could not load the latest Job Applications. The board below is the last good copy, from four minutes ago. Anything you change now may not save.

Deleting this Job Application removes its Requirements, its Coverage and its Analysis. It cannot be undone.

Analysing costs one credit and takes about ten seconds.

Errors, destructive confirmations and anything about money or data say plainly what happened, what state things are in now, and what to press.

Use the domain words from `CONTEXT.md` in the UI, capitalised as it capitalises them: Posting, Job Application, Status, Profile, Requirement, Coverage, Analysis.

Never imply the user is owed a reply — *"Nobody owes you a reply — but it helps to know who is not sending one."* The app speaks first at most once a week, in the nudge above the board, and only ever offers to take the user somewhere. **It never sets a Status on their behalf** — Status is set by the user and never inferred.

States

Nothing out there yet.

Track your first job and the board fills itself in.

Track a job

Get the extension

! Could not load the latest Job Applications.

The board below is the last good copy, from four minutes ago. Anything you change now may not save.

Try again

Dismiss

Loading your Job Applications...

Loading is a skeleton (line fill, 1.8s opacity pulse $1 \rightarrow 0.45$) *plus* a written line, because a skeleton is furniture to a screen reader. **Failure** is a rose border on rose-tint with a 13.5/600 rose heading, the plain explanation in ink-muted, and two buttons. **Empty** is a dashed line-strong frame, the dashed ghost, a serif line at 26px, one sentence of body and at most two quiet buttons. The count line under the toolbar is `aria-live="polite"`.

Accessibility

Contrast	Each accent reads at 4.5:1 or better on its own tint.
Colour is never alone	Every badge says its reading in words as well — "Going cold · 34d", not an amber dot.
Silence, three ways	The tag's words, the tag's colour, and the card's fade. Any one alone is enough to sort by.
Everything is reachable	Every card and row is a real link or button, focusable, with a visible focus ring.
Drag is an enhancement	Drag-to-move on the board sits over a Status select — never the only way to change a Status.
Never opacity for text	Dimming is a token choice (ink-muted / ink-faint), so it can be tuned per surface.

END

Written from the canvas in `.scratch/design-ghosted-boo`. The prose version, which is the one to edit, is `docs/design-system.md`.